

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 56)

Page 277 - The Inter-War Years

Q1. When Thomas Hardy died in 1928, the world was still recovering from the consequences of:

- A. The Boer War
- B. The first World War
- C. The Crimean War
- D. The French Revolution

Answer: B

Q2. What organization had failed to bring about the state of international harmony hoped for by its founders?

- A. The United Nations
- B. The European Union
- C. The League of Nations
- D. The NATO

Answer: C

Q3. In the 1930s, a worldwide financial crisis struck, creating millions of unemployed and regions known as:

- A. Development zones
- B. Distressed areas
- C. Special economic zones
- D. Prosperity belts

Answer: B

Q4. An account of the state of Britain during the 1930s can be found in J.B. Priestley's:

- A. An English Journey
- B. The Good Companions
- C. Angel Pavement
- D. Time and the Conways

Answer: A

Q5. In Germany, the burden of unemployment created conditions exploited by:

- A. Mussolini
- B. Hitler

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C. Stalin

D. Franco

Answer: B

Q6. Mussolini dreamt of a modern Roman Empire and prepared for conquest in:

A. Abyssinia and Libya

B. China and Japan

C. Spain and Portugal

D. Poland and Austria

Answer: A

Q7. In the 1930s, a civil war raged with terrifying savagery in:

A. Italy

B. France

C. Spain

D. Germany

Answer: C

Q8. In these circumstances, many writers became convinced that literature was useless if it did not serve a definite:

A. Aesthetic purpose

B. Social and political purpose

C. Religious purpose

D. Romantic purpose

Answer: B

Q9. The literature of the 1930s returned to the serious mood which had dominated the:

A. Augustan period

B. Mid-Victorian period

C. Elizabethan period

D. Romantic period

Answer: B

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Q10. The Victorians had been mainly preoccupied with the 'condition of England' question and their literature was permeated by:

- A. Non-violent humanitarianism
- B. Violent revolutionary zeal
- C. Classical detachment
- D. Existential despair

Answer: A

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Page 278 - Purpose in Literature

Q1. The writings of the 1930s were as much preoccupied with the condition of:

- A. The whole world
- B. Just England
- C. The rural countryside
- D. The industrial cities only

Answer: A

Q2. What had made the world appear as small a place as Britain a century before?

- A. Telegraphs
- B. Air-travel
- C. Steamships
- D. The radio

Answer: B

Q3. In the 1930s, humanitarian hopefulness had been displaced by:

- A. Apathetic silence
- B. Partisan propaganda
- C. Pure romanticism
- D. Light-hearted comedy

Answer: B

Q4. According to the text, literature is a creative art, written by creative literary artists, and its motive power is:

- A. Logic
- B. Political theory
- C. Imagination
- D. Economics

Answer: C

Q5. A vision of truth is described as the peculiar and special contribution of:

- A. Politicians
- B. A great poet or a great novelist

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C. Sociologists

D. Economists

Answer: B

Q6. Politics, according to the text, has been said to be the art of the:

A. Impossible

B. Desirable

C. Possible

D. Inevitable

Answer: C

Q7. In contrast to politics, the text suggests that poetry is the art of the:

A. Possible

B. Desirable

C. Practical

D. Compromise

Answer: B

Q8. When a poet attempts to harness his talent to current practical problems, he is more likely to:

A. Save mankind

B. Cripple his own imagination

C. Become a great politician

D. Increase his vision of truth

Answer: B

Q9. If a poet loses his vision through a misapplied concern with facts, he is compared to:

A. A soaring eagle

B. A bat doing the flitting of a falcon

C. A rapid falcon condemned to do the flitting of a bat

D. A caged bird

Answer: C

Q10. The text suggests that a poet may see more and speak more saving wisdom from:

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- A. The political cockpit
- B. His ivory tower
- C. The battlefield
- D. The factory floor

Answer: B

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Page 279 - Gerard Manley Hopkins

Q1. Gerard Manley Hopkins published how much poetry during his own lifetime?

- A. Several volumes
- B. Nothing
- C. One famous epic
- D. A few anthologies

Answer: B

Q2. When were Hopkins's collected poems first issued?

- A. 1889
- B. 1900
- C. 1918
- D. 1928

Answer: C

Q3. Hopkins turned Roman Catholic and later joined which order?

- A. The Franciscans
- B. The Dominicans
- C. The Society of Jesus (Jesuits)
- D. The Benedictines

Answer: C

Q4. As a devout Jesuit, Hopkins considered it a religious duty to:

- A. Write religious pamphlets
- B. Preach to the poor
- C. Discontinue writing poetry
- D. Translate the Bible

Answer: C

Q5. What event inspired Hopkins to write 'The Wreck of the Deutschland'?

- A. The death of his father
- B. A shipwreck causing the drowning of five Franciscan nuns

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- C. The outbreak of a war
- D. A personal spiritual crisis

Answer: B

Q6. Hopkins served as Professor of Greek at which university from 1884?

- A. Oxford University
- B. Cambridge University
- C. Dublin University
- D. London University

Answer: C

Q7. Which poem by Hopkins begins 'Glory be to God for dappled things'?

- A. The Wreck of the Deutschland
- B. Pied Beauty
- C. The Windhover
- D. Felix Randal

Answer: B

Q8. To describe his own system of prosody, Hopkins used the term:

- A. Free verse
- B. Blank verse
- C. Sprung rhythm
- D. Syllabic meter

Answer: C

Q9. What word did Hopkins use to denote his aim in the treatment of subject material?

- A. Inscape
- B. Instress
- C. Insight
- D. Epiphany

Answer: A

Q10. Who edited the 1918 volume of Hopkins's poems?

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- A. T.S. Eliot
- B. W.B. Yeats
- C. Robert Bridges
- D. John Pick

Answer: C

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Page 280 - Hopkins's Influence

Q1. The spirit of Victorian times was mostly:

- A. At variance with Hopkins's own spirit
- B. Deeply appreciative of complex spiritual probing
- C. Identical to Hopkins's worldview
- D. Entirely devoid of religion

Answer: A

Q2. Before 1914, the educated classes had enjoyed long periods of:

- A. War and famine
- B. Peace and prosperity
- C. Social revolution
- D. Religious persecution

Answer: B

Q3. All the simple and comfortable life of the educated classes was changed by:

- A. The death of Queen Victoria
- B. The coming of war in 1914
- C. The rise of industrialism
- D. The financial crisis of 1929

Answer: B

Q4. After 1914, the smooth romantic writings which had satisfied the older generation now appeared to the younger generation as:

- A. Profound and comforting
- B. Superficial and empty
- C. Ahead of their time
- D. Dangerously subversive

Answer: B

Q5. After the outbreak of war, religion requiring hardly more than a quiet round of Christian observances had:

- A. Grown in popularity

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- B. Ceased to satisfy
- C. Become the only comfort
- D. Been legally banned

Answer: B

Q6. The new generation viewed life not as a pastoral landscape, but as:

- A. A bustling city
- B. A quiet garden
- C. A prospect of granite mountains and chasms
- D. An empty desert

Answer: C

Q7. When Hopkins's poems were introduced, they were recognized as the work of:

- A. A superficial romantic
- B. A spiritual explorer
- C. A political pamphleteer
- D. A traditional Victorian

Answer: B

Q8. Hopkins's poetry acted for the new generation not as a smoothing-plane, but as a:

- A. Rock-drill driving down into realities
- B. Gentle breeze of comfort
- C. Distracting fantasy
- D. Heavy burden

Answer: A

Q9. Who found Hopkins's realities useful for their own purposes?

- A. Only the deeply religious
- B. Only the irreligious
- C. Religious and irreligious alike
- D. Only Jesuit priests

Answer: C

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Q10. The text notes that because they were tired of easy poetry, a good many of his followers neglected to observe that:

- A. There is no virtue in difficulty as an end in itself
- B. Poetry should never rhyme
- C. Romanticism is the only true art
- D. All traditional poetry is bad

Answer: A

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Page 281 - T.S. Eliot and Obscurity

Q1. The far-reaching influence of Hopkins after 1918 encouraged lesser minds to foster the illusion that:

- A. Clarity is superior to obscurity
- B. Clarity is inferior to obscurity
- C. Poetry must be politically engaged
- D. Form does not matter

Answer: B

Q2. According to the text, a good poet is never obscure if:

- A. They use free verse
- B. They write about nature
- C. What they say can be comprehended by those who learn their language
- D. They explain their poems in prose

Answer: C

Q3. Milton is considered obscure until we:

- A. Understand his political views
- B. Master the Miltonic language
- C. Read his biographies
- D. Memorize his sonnets

Answer: B

Q4. Many of Hopkins's imitators are obscure because:

- A. They write in a foreign language
- B. They have no language of their own and nothing original to say
- C. They only use sprung rhythm
- D. They are too intelligent for their readers

Answer: B

Q5. What is the text's view on any literary cult?

- A. It is highly beneficial
- B. It is deplorable

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C. It is a necessary phase of art

D. It guarantees great literature

Answer: B

Q6. A literary cult is said to destroy the faculty of:

A. Rhythmic composition

B. Rhyming

C. Independent creation and independent critical judgment

D. Memorization

Answer: C

Q7. It is difficult to separate the Hopkins cult from the cult of:

A. W.B. Yeats

B. T.S. Eliot

C. W.H. Auden

D. Ezra Pound

Answer: B

Q8. T.S. Eliot published his first poems (Prufrock and Other Observations) in:

A. 1915

B. 1917

C. 1918

D. 1922

Answer: B

Q9. Where was T.S. Eliot born?

A. England

B. France

C. The United States

D. Ireland

Answer: C

Q10. With which poem published in 1922 did Eliot establish his reputation as the leading living poet of the

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English-speaking world?

- A. Ash Wednesday
- B. The Journey of the Magi
- C. The Waste Land
- D. Prufrock

Answer: C